WORKSHOP HANDOUT

# Decentralized curation

Putting self-interest to work for the public good.

Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden · Wednesday 14 October 2026, 14:00 to 15:20

## Who judges what matters?

At this meeting, I heard frustration with how research is judged and rewarded. The proposal uses private incentives for assessment and correction to pursue credible consensus. Funding public goods is our worked example.

## The funding application

1. **Set terms:** funding budget, public policy and fixed economic rules.
2. **Nominate:** identify a beneficiary, publish evidence, request a weight and deposit the funding asset.
3. **Judge relevance:** stake-backed, randomly drawn juries seal and reveal scores under the policy.
4. **Appeal:** crowdfund score proposals during a bounded window. Unopposed: forfeiture, full refund, no fee or profit. Opposed: jury target doubles. Payouts follow inverse distance to the final score.
5. **Fund:** eligible weights split the continuing flow after any required holdback.
6. **Challenge and revisit:** once scored, claims can face external arbitration when no relevance case is open. Re-scoring can change future funding.

## Weight is not a funding share

**Effective weight = the lower of requested weight and curated score.** Score ratios set funding weights, not ratios of public benefit. A sole eligible positive weight takes the full flow. The NumPy example is illustrative. The pool pays jury fees first; contest funds cover shortfalls.

## Judgment needs checks

Metrics inform judgment; our scores can be gamed too. Clear criteria, evidence and accessible challenges matter. Neither stake nor agreement establishes expertise, truth or public benefit.

Where configured, a temporary circuit-breaker holder may permanently stop future accrual once, before expiry. They cannot take prior accrual.

## Try, read, stay in touch

The room

Published preprint

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## Today: experience one layer

Read the policy, score alone, seal, then reveal. This hosted game uses equal seats and points. Its band follows the mean and standard deviation; rewards depend on closeness. At essentially zero spread, distance forfeits switch off.

Workshop simplification: each round with opened scores pays the full base reward, even when those scores all agree.

Use an alias or observe. Revealed scores and standings are visible; adversarial role-play may be assigned. Ask before photographing results. The host wipes session results afterward; they have no automatic expiry.

Keep score proofs private. This game's reporting bounty is absent from the inspected contracts. The game does not run accuracy disputes, jury selection, appeals or a funding stream.

## Example pool policy

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

Score the work identified by each nomination. If entries claim the same work, credit that shared work once across them; distinct contributions by the same beneficiary remain eligible.

Docket: Inkscape, Linux, PDF, LaTeX, arXiv, NumPy.

## From experience to evidence

Ask whether the game rewarded better evidence use or merely agreement. This exercise cannot establish reliable judgments or resistance to collusion.

Arrow is a planned precursor experiment at Octant: invited experts score a real docket under a published policy. It assumes honesty, competence and non-collusion; it does not validate the full permissionless system. octant.build

Room: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/r/leiden

Join: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/join/

Published preprint, version 1.2.0: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23313625.

Release source · Public mechanism and evidence limits. Later hardening is outside this archived release.

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Decentralized Curation research by Ferit Tunçer.

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